

E012

Information Technology Management and Leadership

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a regional hospital, the electronic health record, the lab system, and the billing system all run on one database server with no failover. Nurses rate the health record easy to use, and the lab system is two years old. What is the biggest infrastructure risk?

- A. The single database server with no failover.
- B. The age of the lab system.
- C. The usability of the health record.
- D. Every component is equally risky.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An identity server handles sign-in for email, the VPN, and the HR portal. It goes down. What is the most likely effect?

- A. Only the identity server is affected.
- B. Nothing, because applications always run independently.
- C. Only email is affected, because it is used most.
- D. Users cannot sign in to email, the VPN, or the HR portal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A company's strategy is to launch online sales within two years. IT has budget for one major initiative this year. The CIO personally prefers open-source tools, and the data center was renovated last year. Which initiative best aligns IT with the strategy?

- A. Replace every desktop with the newest model.
- B. Build a scalable e-commerce platform with payment integration.
- C. Pick whichever technology is most innovative.
- D. Upgrade the data center's cooling system.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A new hire on a fully remote network team graduated with honors and is eager to learn, but has never worked with the company's firewall change process. Which leadership style fits this task?

- A. Supporting — mainly encouragement with little direction.
- B. Directing — clear instructions and close follow-up.
- C. Delegating — let them handle it independently.
- D. Delegating, because honors graduates are ready.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A senior engineer has handled firewall changes for years and is highly committed to the team. Which leadership style fits this task?

- A. Directing.
- B. The same style used for every team member.
- C. Delegating.
- D. Coaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A CIO with 20 years in banking shares a vision of becoming the most customer-focused IT group in the industry. She coaches individuals on their growth and encourages staff to challenge old ways of working. Which leadership style is this?

- A. Laissez-faire.
- B. Transformational.
- C. Autocratic.
- D. Transactional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager sets clear ticket-resolution targets, pays bonuses to those who hit them, and applies corrective action to those who miss. Which leadership style is this?

- A.** Transactional.
- B.** Transformational.
- C.** Laissez-faire.
- D.** Servant leadership.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A company's mobile device software can legally track employees' phone locations 24 hours a day. The goal is to protect company data on those phones. The vendor offers a 20% discount on its full tracking bundle. What is the most ethical approach?

- A.** Buy the full bundle while it is discounted.
- B.** Track location around the clock, since it is legal.
- C.** Never manage employee devices at all.
- D.** Collect only what protecting company data requires and tell employees what is collected and why.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Nightly backups on a storage array bought in 2021 are failing. The disk is full because old backups were not purged. The purge job was disabled during last month's migration, and the migration checklist had no step to turn it back on. The backup software is a well-known brand. What is the root cause?

- A.** The choice of backup software brand.
- B.** The disk is full.
- C.** The migration checklist lacked a step to re-enable the purge job.
- D.** The old backups were not purged.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Five departments have submitted IT project requests that together exceed the team's capacity by 60%. Marketing's vice president is the loudest advocate, and Finance submitted its request first. What is the best way to decide?

- A. Have a governance committee rank requests using clear criteria tied to strategic value.
- B. Fund the requests with the most senior or vocal sponsor.
- C. Give every department an equal share of capacity.
- D. Fund requests in the order received.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An IT director with a ninth-floor corner office spends her week preparing the quarterly budget, building staff schedules, tracking project metrics against plan, and presenting a new vision for how IT will serve customers. Which task is leadership rather than management?

- A. All of them, since anything a director does is leadership.
- B. Preparing the quarterly budget.
- C. Presenting the new vision for how IT will serve customers.
- D. Tracking project metrics against plan.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is management rather than leadership?

- A. Inspiring the team around a shared vision.
- B. Building a coalition of supporters for a change.
- C. None; management and leadership are the same thing.
- D. Building a project schedule and tracking variances against it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

At a regional hospital, the electronic health record, the lab system, and the billing system all run on one database server with no failover. ~~Nurses rate the health record easy to use, and the lab system is two years old.~~ What is the biggest infrastructure risk?

Target word: largest risk **Decides:** Three systems depend on one server with no redundancy.

A	Correct	Its failure would take down all three systems at once.
B	Adjacent category	Two years is not old, and it is one system, not a shared dependency.
C	Camouflage	Usability ratings do not create an outage risk.
D	Absolute language	Shared, non-redundant components carry more risk.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

An identity server handles sign-in for email, the VPN, and the HR portal. It goes down. What is the most likely effect?

Target word: trace the dependency forward **Decides:** All three rely on the identity server to sign users in.

A	Dropped element	Drops the services that depend on it.
B	Absolute language	Shared services create dependencies.
C	Confusion set	Usage level does not decide dependency.
D	Correct	Every dependent service loses authentication.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A company's strategy is to launch online sales within two years. IT has budget for one major initiative this year. ~~The CIO personally prefers open source tools, and the data center was renovated last year.~~ Which initiative best aligns IT with the strategy?

Target word: aligned initiative **Decides:** The goal is online sales.

A	Adjacent category	A routine refresh, not tied to online sales.
B	Correct	Directly enables the strategic goal.
C	Confusion set	Innovation for its own sake is not alignment.
D	Camouflage	The renovation detail does not connect to the strategy.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A new hire ~~on a fully remote network team graduated with honors and~~ is eager to learn, but has never worked with the company's firewall change process. Which leadership style fits this task?

Target word: style for low competence, high commitment **Decides:** No experience with the specific task.

A	Adjacent category	Fits people who have the skill but lack confidence.
B	Correct	New to the task means the person needs structure first.
C	Inverted operation	That style fits skilled, committed people.
D	Camouflage	Credentials do not equal competence on this task.

5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

A senior engineer has handled firewall changes for years and is highly committed to the team. Which leadership style fits this task?

Target word: style for high competence, high commitment **Decides:** Skilled and committed.

A	Inverted operation	Close direction fits people new to a task.
B	Absolute language	Situational leadership adapts to each person and task.
C	Correct	Skilled, committed people do best with autonomy.
D	Adjacent category	Coaching fits people still building skill.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A CIO ~~with 20 years in banking~~ shares a vision of becoming the most customer-focused IT group in the industry. She coaches individuals on their growth and encourages staff to challenge old ways of working. Which leadership style is this?

Target word: name the style **Decides:** Vision, individual coaching, and intellectual challenge.

A	Adjacent category	Hands-off leadership with little guidance.
B	Correct	Inspiring vision and developing people are its hallmarks.
C	Inverted operation	Decides alone; this CIO invites challenge.
D	Confusion set	Relies on rewards and corrections, not vision.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A manager sets clear ticket-resolution targets, pays bonuses to those who hit them, and applies corrective action to those who miss. Which leadership style is this?

Target word: name the style — reverse of the vision item **Decides:** Targets, rewards, and corrections.

A	Correct	An exchange of rewards for performance.
B	Inverted operation	No vision or personal development is described.
C	Confusion set	Laissez-faire gives little structure; this manager gives a lot.
D	Adjacent category	Focuses on serving and growing the team.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A company's mobile device software can legally track employees' phone locations 24 hours a day. The goal is to protect company data on those phones. ~~The vendor offers a 20% discount on its full tracking bundle.~~ What is the most ethical approach?

Target word: ethical data practice **Decides:** The purpose is data protection, not location.

A	Camouflage	Price does not justify more intrusion.
B	Adjacent category	Legal compliance is a floor, not the ethical test.
C	Absolute language	Reasonable device management protects data ethically.
D	Correct	Data minimization and transparency match the purpose.

9. Answer C Concept 6

Nightly backups ~~on a storage array bought in 2021~~ are failing. The disk is full because old backups were not purged. The purge job was disabled during last month's migration, and the migration checklist had no step to turn it back on. ~~The backup software is a well-known brand.~~ What is the root cause?

Target word: deepest cause **Decides:** The checklist gap allowed the purge job to stay off.

A	Camouflage	The brand played no part in the chain.
B	Dropped element	A symptom; stopping here drops the causes behind it.
C	Correct	Fixing this prevents the whole chain from repeating.
D	Confusion set	An intermediate cause, not the gap that allowed it.

10. Answer A Concept 7

Five departments have submitted IT project requests that together exceed the team's capacity by 60%. ~~Marketing's vice president is the loudest advocate, and Finance submitted its request first.~~ What is the best way to decide?

Target word: prioritization mechanism **Decides:** Demand exceeds capacity and needs a fair basis.

A	Correct	Transparent, strategy-based ranking is the governance role.
B	Camouflage	Influence is not a value criterion.
C	Dropped element	Drops strategic value from the decision.
D	Confusion set	Arrival order ignores value.

11. Answer C Concept 8

An IT director ~~with a ninth floor corner office~~ spends her week preparing the quarterly budget, building staff schedules, tracking project metrics against plan, and presenting a new vision for how IT will serve customers. Which task is leadership rather than management?

Target word: identify the leadership task **Decides:** Setting direction and aligning people.

A	Absolute language	Role title does not change the type of activity.
B	Confusion set	Budgeting is a management function.
C	Correct	Setting direction is a core leadership function.
D	Adjacent category	Controlling against plan is management.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

Which activity is management rather than leadership?

Target word: identify the management task — reverse direction **Decides:** Planning and controlling.

A	Inverted operation	That is leadership.
B	Confusion set	Aligning people is leadership.
C	Absolute language	They are distinct, complementary functions.
D	Correct	Planning and control are management.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Infrastructure dependencies and single points of failure	Map what depends on what; a shared component with no redundancy takes down everything that relies on it.	Judging risk by how visible or new a system is.	Several systems relying on one server, link, or service.
2	IT-business alignment	IT priorities should follow directly from the organization's strategic goals.	Choosing projects by technical appeal or personal preference.	A stated business goal plus a limited IT budget.
3	Situational leadership	Match the style to the person's competence and commitment on the task: directing for new, coaching and supporting in between, delegating for skilled and committed.	Using one style for everyone or judging readiness by credentials.	A description of someone's experience with a specific task.
4	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders inspire with vision and develop people; transactional leaders manage through clear targets, rewards, and corrections.	Calling any effective leader transformational.	Vision and coaching vs. bonuses and penalties.
5	Ethical use of technology	Legal does not mean ethical; collect only what the purpose needs, be transparent, and weigh the impact on people.	Treating legal permission as the whole test.	A capability the law allows but that intrudes on people.
6	Root cause analysis	Keep asking why until you reach the process or control gap that allowed the failure.	Stopping at the first symptom or the nearest technical fault.	A chain of because-statements.
7	IT governance and prioritization	A governance body ranks competing requests using transparent criteria tied to strategic value.	First-come or loudest-voice prioritization.	More project requests than capacity.
8	Management vs. leadership	Management plans, budgets, organizes, and controls; leadership sets direction, aligns people, and motivates.	Treating the two as the same, or anything a senior person does as leadership.	A list of a manager's tasks.

Course scope (public description): Information Technology Management and Leadership addresses the technical and human elements of managing technology within an organization. A technology leader must be able to identify the components of a technology infrastructure, including all of the technologies used within an organization and how they relate to one another. This is crucial for building effective technology solutions, improving efficiency and processes, and knowing how to identify and resolve technical problems. Equipped with this fundamental skill, students in the course will analyze a scenario to create a technology management strategy for an organization. This course considers the ethical responsibilities of leadership and management and the appropriate use of technological solutions within an organization. The course also provides opportunities for students to develop their own leadership strategy, an essential element of effectively influencing and organizing the people who will carry out technology strategies at the ground level. There are no prerequisites for this course.